

out a Money Story of scarcity, which causes them to hoard more 'stuff'. Or they're so busy that they don't have the time to research where they're spending and investing their money, so their Money Story by default becomes that it's okay to operate outside their values when they're time-poor.

If we're operating this way, and we look closely at this behaviour, we might recognise that we're not behaving like rational consumers. Rational choice theory is an economic concept that suggests individuals will always make rational, cautious and logical decisions. The problem for most of us as consumers today is we don't have all the information to make these decisions and don't know where to go and find it. Added to this is the fact that we're being marketed to at every waking moment by a system that doesn't want us to behave rationally or be informed enough to do so.

This Money Story of not being enough, of not having enough, is one that is deeply ingrained and one that is driving too many of us to behave in a way that, if we're honest, we're kind of ashamed of. But it's important not to look away embarrassed or to ignore this story and subsequent behaviour but instead to recognise them, acknowledge them and do something about them.

The truth is most of us are living out unconscious, unexamined sets of assumptions—our Money Stories—that drive our behaviour. What I want you to do is to recognise this, to challenge your assumptions and the stories and messages you're carrying and to ask if they're serving you.

For more than 40 years, Lynne Twist has been a recognised global visionary committed to alleviating poverty, ending world hunger and supporting social justice and environmental sustainability. According to Lynne, if you want a clear picture of your priorities in life, who you are and what you care about, look at your spending. In a conversation with Oprah Winfrey, Lynne says, 'Yes! Your chequebook really tells you what you care about. You can also include your credit card bill and your bank statements. They show you exactly where your priorities are. Sometimes you'll find that what you are doing with your money is not very aligned with your soul'.

This is often the paradox of the Money Stories we carry. Too often they're inherent money beliefs that, when we learn to identify and